

Quality

The quality of your stream is really important in deciding how many people eventually end up watching it. The Video tab in settings allows you to decide what the quality and resolution of your stream is going to be. A stable, high-speed internet connection is integral if you intend on ensuring both these parameters are high. It is also important to know that the greater your resolution, the greater the CPU resources used is going to be. The Base (Canvas) Resolution can be left at its default value of *1080p*. However, an output resolution of *720p or higher* is only recommended if you have a decent CPU.

CPU Usage Preset

The CPU Usage Preset decides the speed at which your CPU is going to encode the video during the live stream. Live streaming always involves a trade-off between the performance of your CPU and the quality of your stream. The greater the speed at which the CPU encodes the video, the lower the amount of CPU used is going to be. Setting this setting to *Very Fast* can be a good option to optimise quality and performance.

Dynamic Bitrate

Dynamic Bitrate is a really important setting to enhance the video viewing experience of your viewers. Enabling dynamic bitrate basically means that in case your network quality begins to drop, the software drops the bitrate to an appropriate level to avoid dropping frames, which causes viewing issues for your audience. If you do not enable dynamic bitrate, the bitrate is set to a constant value. In case the quality of your network drops, the software will compensate by dropping video frames to keep the bitrate up. To enable dynamic bitrate, go to the Advanced tab in the Streamlabs OBS settings. Here, scroll down and check the box that says *Dynamically Change Bitrate When Dropping Frames While Streaming*.

Sources

Your sources are the video feeds that you intend on streaming. These may be your whole desktop, your webcam output or a specific window from your desktop. You can even choose multiple sources to stream. You can also choose specific widgets as a source. If you want to add a source, you can click on the + sign on your dashboard and choose the kind of source that you would like to add. For game streaming, the *Game Capture* functionality works best as a source. You can also choose *Automatic Game Capture*, in which case the